

Super-charging Your Community Engagement

Presented by Ken Aponte

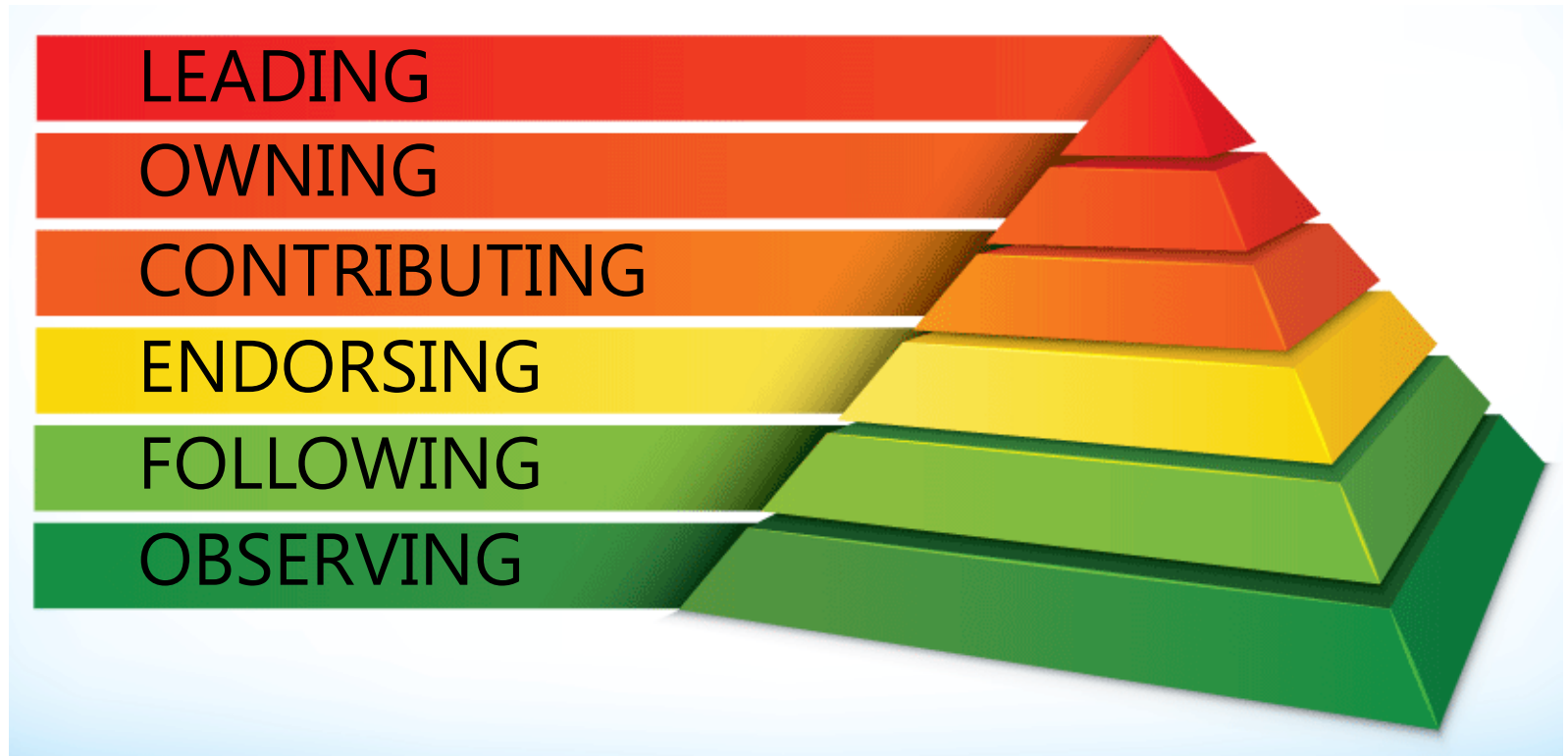
Objectives of Engagement

*Bring people to the
community. Make them
happy once they get there.
Get them to come back*

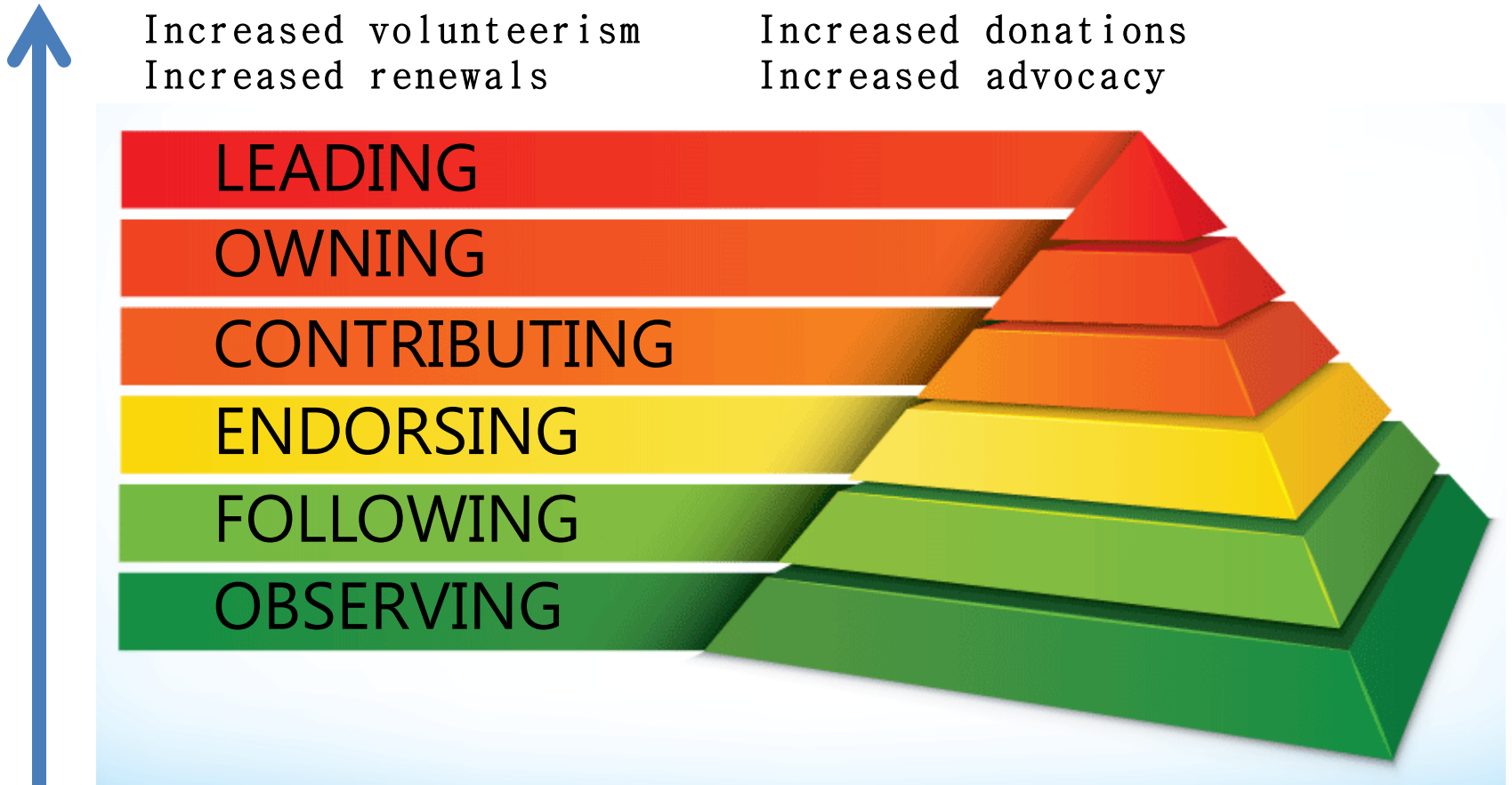


*Us marketing types call
this - acquire, retain and
renew*

The Engagement Pyramid



Engagement and ROI



Your Engagement Checklist

☐ Participate with Ease

☐ Keep the Content Fresh

☐ Subscribe, subscribe, subscribe

☐ Be a Leader

☐ Reward and Recognize

☐ Encourage Power Users

☐ Welcome New People

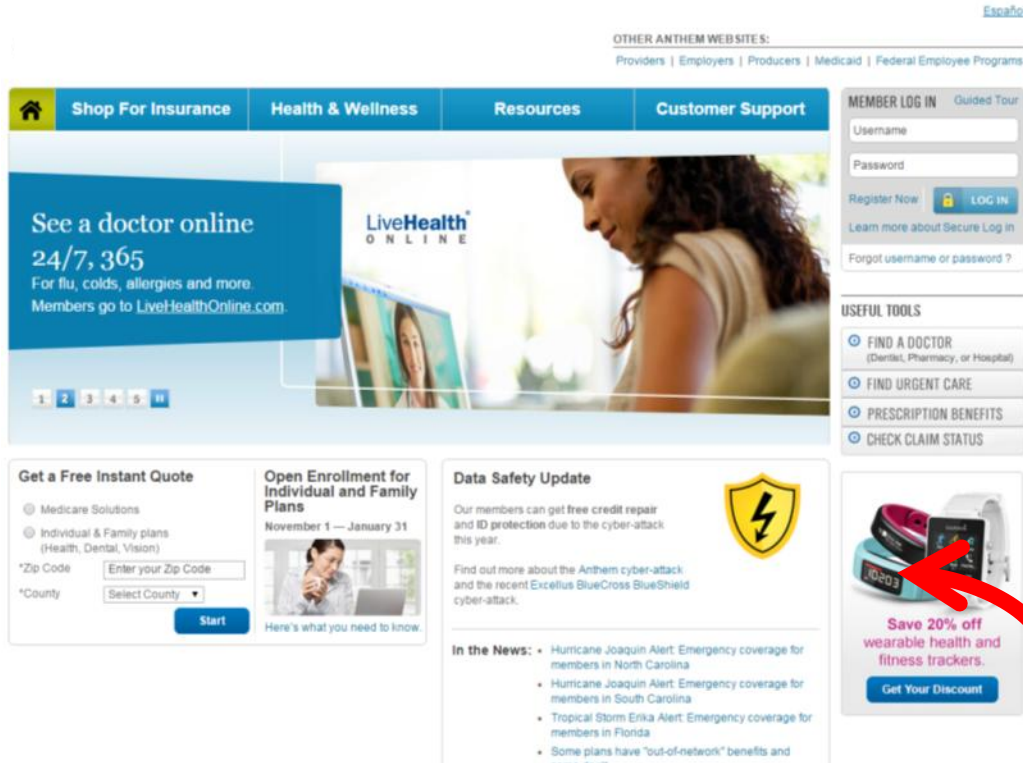
☐ Encourage Profile Building

☐ Engage Your Other Channels

☐ Create a Seamless Ecosystem (integrate!)

☐ Identify the Metrics that Matter

Participate With Ease



- Users won't want to participate in anything with a confusing or clunky interface (UX / UI)
- Users need
 - Strong calls to action to draw the eye
 - Minimum navigation elements that emphasize the most important things you want them to do
 - Moving and scrolling images are distracting
 - Avoid multiple layers of menus

NO!

- 1 My user experience and interface are way crazy right now
- 5 We have a slimmed down navigation, zero clutter and strong calls to action

Keep the Content Fresh

Create a new editorial calendar item.
List View.

January 2013

month week day

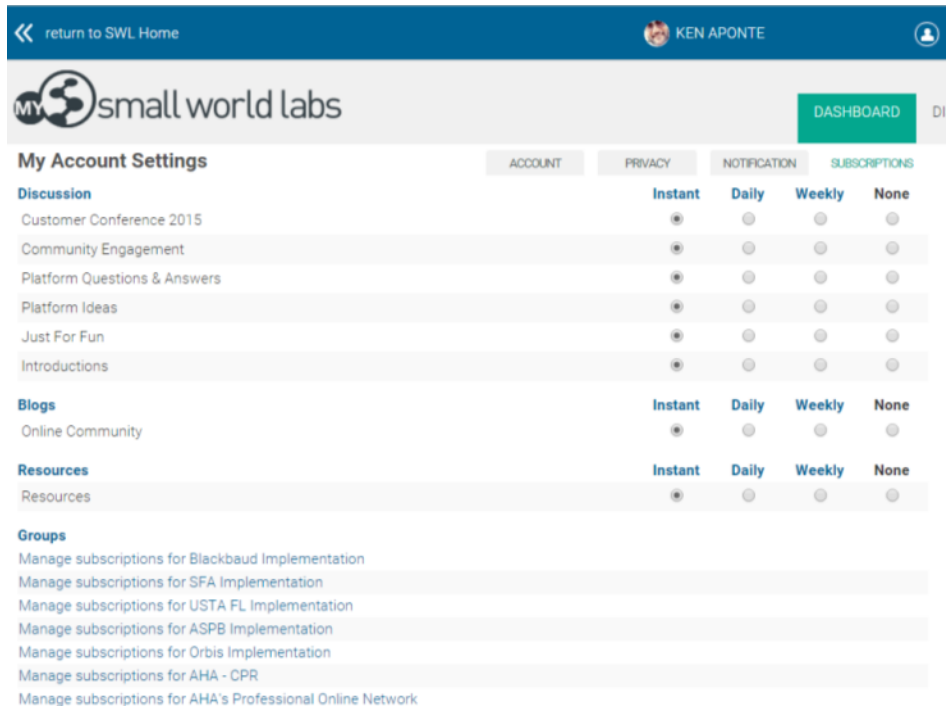
Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
30	31	1	2 About Us Page Blogpost on SAAS	3 Software Client Case Study	4 Whitepaper on accounting software	5 How to Plan Your 2013 Editorial Calendar
6 New Sign-Up Page	7 Weekly Newsletter	8 Finance Client Case Study	9 Executive Report on Cloud Computing	10 Infographic on new market opportunities	11 Ad for mobile devices	12 Article on New Regulations
13 Tutorial for upgrade	14 Weekly Newsletter News Release announcing new board member	15 New Contact Us page Tutorial Video 1 Support email 1	16 Landing Page testing new tagline Dashboard Tutorial	17 E-book on Content Strategy	18 Webinar on after sales service	19 Presentation for board meeting
20 Special Offer email	21 Weekly Newsletter Tutorial Video 2	22 Whitepaper on Industry Trends	23 Blogpost on Top 5 Marketing Strategies	24 Construction Client Case Study	25 Executive Report on Big Data	26 3 Day Follow-Up Email
27	28 Weekly Newsletter News Release announcing salesforce integration	29 E-book on corporate LinkedIn pages 5 Day Follow-Up email	30 Graph on homepage showing sales growth	31 Homepage Intro Video Tweet about special offer	1	2
3	4	5	6	7	8	9

- The cornerstone of any successful community will be how its members value the time they spend there
- A “valuable” experience delivers timely and interesting information on a regular basis
- A content calendar contains the following:
 - What information is being delivered
 - How it is delivered (blog, forums, resource library, etc)
 - The date it will be delivered
 - Who is responsible for delivering it

1 What is an editorial or content calendar?

5 We use a content calendar AND we keep to it!

Subscribe, subscribe, subscribe

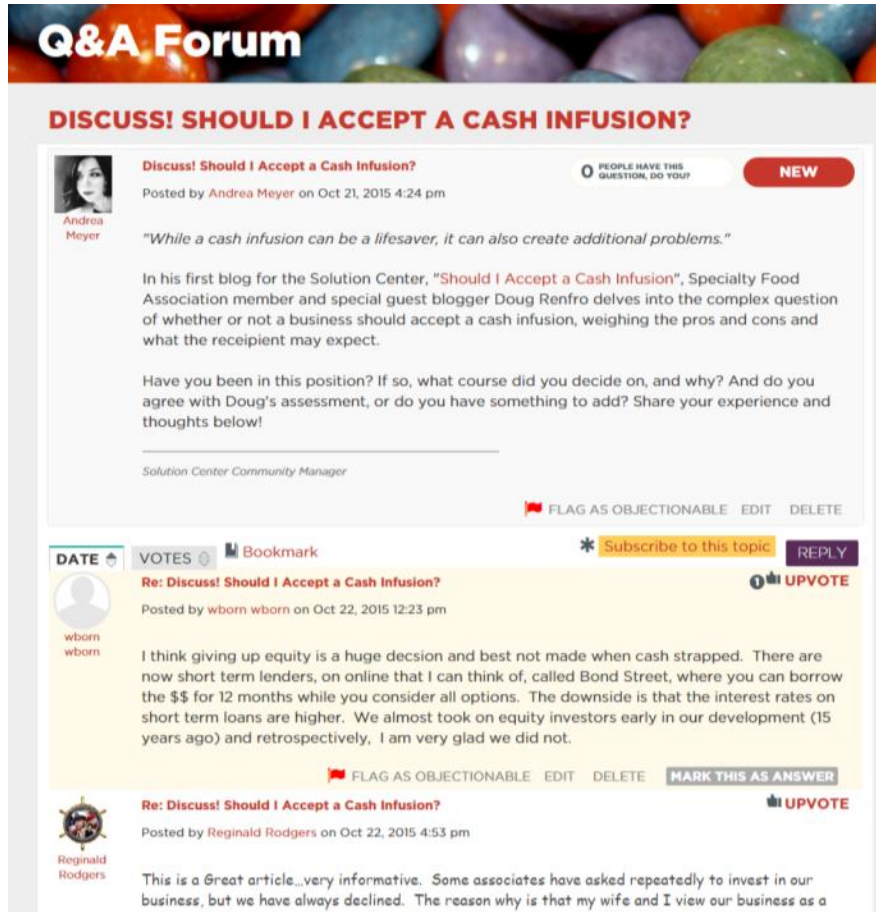


- Data shows that communities where members are not receiving notifications (and hence don't know what's happening within the community) fail at a much higher rate than those that aggressively push notifications to its membership
- This may be a reason why 50% of your membership hasn't come back to visit the last 12 months
- There are a couple of options you can use to ensure subscription on our platform:
 - Use action workflows to auto-subscribe every new member to everything on a daily digest basis
 - Enable Subscribe on Post in open forums
 - Enable Subscribe All in group forums

1 Ehhhh...we let folks decide on their own because we don't want o hurt their feelings

5 We auto subscribe to everything and visibly point people to help them dial back

Be A Leader



The screenshot shows a forum post by Andrea Meyer on October 21, 2015, at 4:24 pm. The post is titled "DISCUSS! Should I Accept a Cash Infusion?" and includes a quote: "While a cash infusion can be a lifesaver, it can also create additional problems." The post is part of a discussion on whether a business should accept a cash infusion. Below the post, there are two replies. The first reply is from "wbom wbom" on October 22, 2015, at 12:23 pm, discussing the decision to give up equity. The second reply is from Reginald Rodgers on October 22, 2015, at 4:53 pm, stating that the business has always declined such offers.

Q&A Forum

DISCUSS! SHOULD I ACCEPT A CASH INFUSION?

Discuss! Should I Accept a Cash Infusion?

Posted by Andrea Meyer on Oct 21, 2015 4:24 pm

0 PEOPLE HAVE THIS QUESTION, DO YOU?

NEW

"While a cash infusion can be a lifesaver, it can also create additional problems."

In his first blog for the Solution Center, "Should I Accept a Cash Infusion", Specialty Food Association member and special guest blogger Doug Renfro delves into the complex question of whether or not a business should accept a cash infusion, weighing the pros and cons and what the recipient may expect.

Have you been in this position? If so, what course did you decide on, and why? And do you agree with Doug's assessment, or do you have something to add? Share your experience and thoughts below!

Solution Center Community Manager

FLAG AS OBJECTIONABLE EDIT DELETE

DATE VOTES Bookmark

Re: Discuss! Should I Accept a Cash Infusion?

Posted by wbom wbom on Oct 22, 2015 12:23 pm

I think giving up equity is a huge decision and best not made when cash strapped. There are now short term lenders, on online that I can think of, called Bond Street, where you can borrow the \$\$ for 12 months while you consider all options. The downside is that the interest rates on short term loans are higher. We almost took on equity investors early in our development (15 years ago) and retrospectively, I am very glad we did not.

FLAG AS OBJECTIONABLE EDIT DELETE MARK THIS AS ANSWER

Re: Discuss! Should I Accept a Cash Infusion?

Posted by Reginald Rodgers on Oct 22, 2015 4:53 pm

This is a Great article...very informative. Some associates have asked repeatedly to invest in our business, but we have always declined. The reason why is that my wife and I view our business as a

- Staff should act as an example for all other members of the community
- At minimum consider the following:
 - The entire organization should be checking and participating in the community the same way they do every morning when they check their email
 - Everyone on your team should have a complete profile and somehow integrated into the content calendar
 - You should be answering questions, starting discussions and just be seen as an active participant
 - Be human in your interactions

1 It's just me in the community and I am content on sitting back and watching

5 Everyone in my organization is an active member of the community

Reward and Recognize

The screenshot shows the IFT connect user interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'IFT | connect' and links for 'Edit Page' and 'Admin Panel'. Below this is a secondary navigation bar with 'Dashboard', 'Groups', 'Open Discussions', 'People Search', and 'eMentor'. The main content area displays the profile of a user named Erika. It includes a profile picture, a list of badges (IFT15, a speech bubble with '4', and a blue circle with '5'), and a 'User Actions' section with links for 'Edit Profile', 'View All Photos', 'Send Message', and 'Add as Connection'. The 'Education History' section shows a 'Doctorate Degree or Equivalent' in 'Food Science/Technology' from '03/16/2015'. The 'Employment History' section lists roles at 'Buhler AG' (Management Trainee / Project Engineer from 09/2015 to 09/2015) and 'German Institute of Food Technologies DiL' (Research Associate from 11/2011 to 07/2015). The 'About Me' section lists interests in food engineering, microbiology, processing, safety, defense, globalization, grains, lab equipment, nonthermal processing, proteins, sustainability, and tree nuts. The 'Member Activity' section shows a post about a call for volunteers for technical research paper reviewers, posted by Erika Sylvie Georget in the Nonthermal Processing Division on Oct 30 at 9:32am CDT. A sidebar on the right shows a 'Connection' section with a total of 1 connection and a list of connected users including Dr. Geoffrey W. Smith, Kathiravan Krishnan, Kim Kwak, Lori A. Conley, and Ma Kaye.

- You should create a gamification **strategy** that rewards people from the top to the bottom, from the moment they come through the front door
- Our platform has the following capabilities to support badging and recognition:
 - We track 200+ actions within the community. We also track how many times each action is taken
 - We track cumulative points for all actions taken in the community
 - For those communities integrated with the org's CRM / AMS, we can reward badges based on information coming from those systems
- Find ways to reward for offline activity too!

1 No time for this nonsense

5 Active badging and recognition for all in our community. Yay us!

Encourage Power Users



- Power users sit at the top of the engagement pyramid. They act on your behalf and take the onus off of you to have to be involved in every conversation
- They are free resource and you should recognize them:
 - We can apply advanced styling on profile pages to the “power user” segment
 - Some client go so far as to reward their power users offline (gift programs and the like)
 - Use Featured Member blocks to highlight power users
 - Use persistent badges in Forums to let everyone know they are talking to a power use
 - Cross promote their content

1 *All members are created equal – Karl Marx*

5 Power users make my life easier. We recognize them in and out of the community

Welcome New People

From: community@smallworldlabs.com <Demo Site >
Subject: Welcome to my.smallworldlabs!



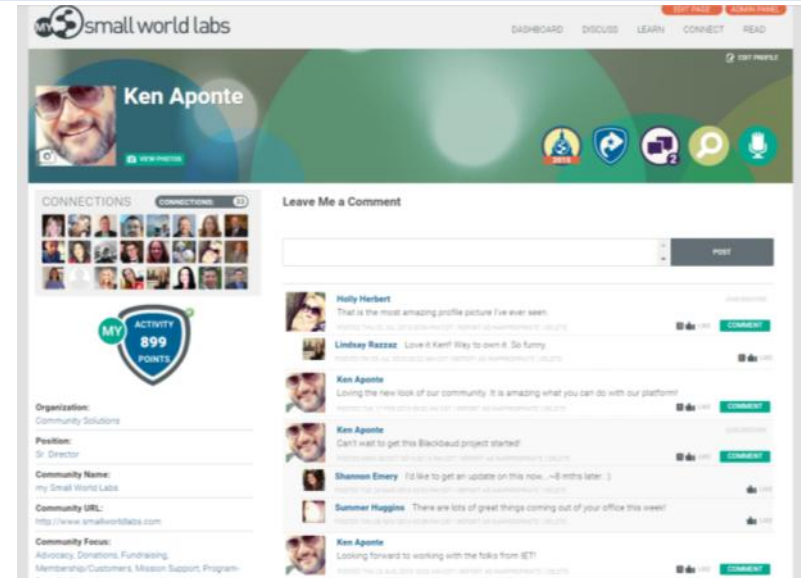
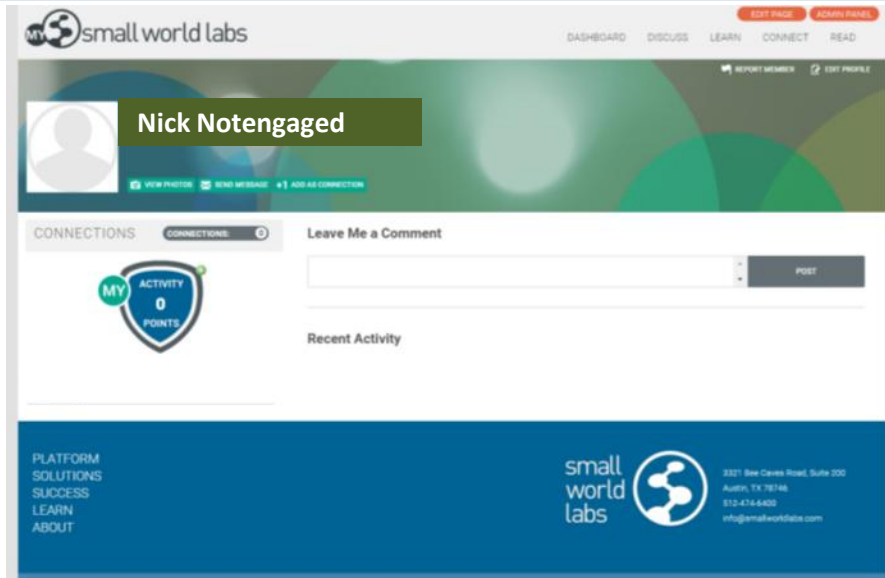
- People who get an extended welcome (automated or not) tend to take more actions early in their membership
- Giving people a warm welcome includes:
 - Personalized private message welcoming them to the community thus humanizing the experience
 - Automated private message that includes valuable information about the community (at left)
 - Build an on boarding program that captures the information you want without overwhelming the user

1 Our members should just be happy they are allowed in the door

5 We have an amped up welcome program that excites our members

Encourage Profile Building

Which of these people would you want to hang out with?



- Full profiles with profile information and a photo makes an individual more engaging to others and is an indication that they are more interested in being part of your community
- SWL Community Platforms tracks updates to profile data and uploads of profile photos. Try marketing to those who haven't done one or the other or perhaps build reward programs to encourage profile building?

1 Anonymity is fine on our platform. I would rather not have people talking to each other

5 We have fun marketing to folks without profiles or photos

Engage Your Other Channels

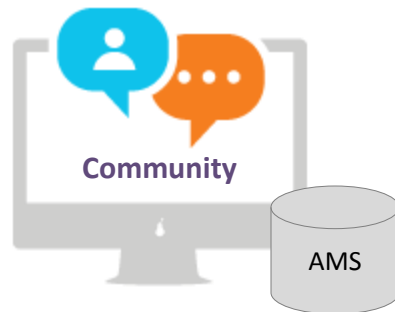


- Your online community is the electronic manifestation of your physical organization
- Community should be the hub of all your activities
- All communications and interactions should drive traffic back to your community where you can control the conversation, look and feel
- You should be in lock-step with your Marketing team (and be on THEIR content calendar!)
- Community drives ROI just like Facebook, newsletters, email campaigns can. Find ways to use it!

1 We like to live in our own little world. Our Org really doesn't know the community exists

5 Community is integrated in all Org channels – social media, newsletters, website

Create a Seamless Experience

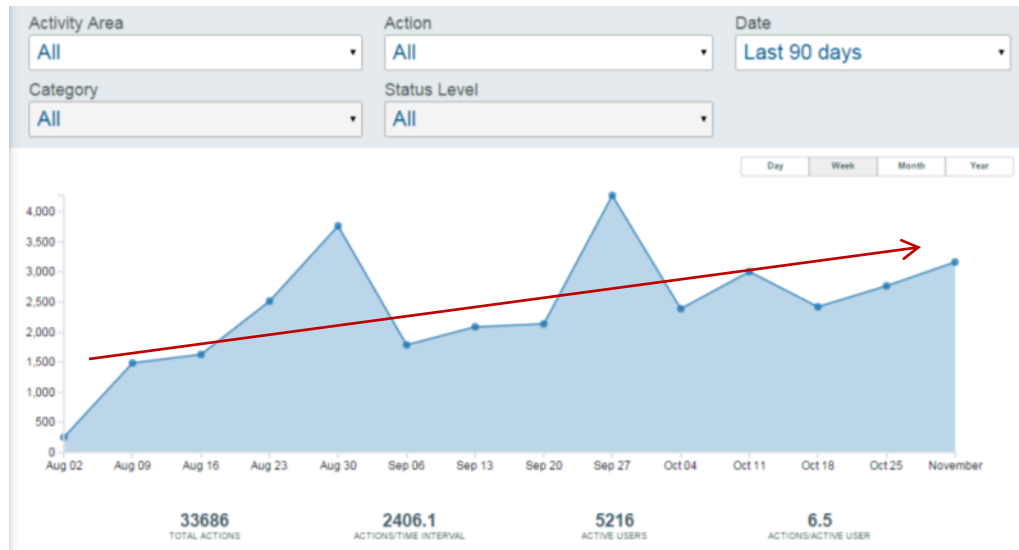


- If you have a CRM or AMS then you should think about integrating it with the community
 - The information from the community can inform the user experience within the community
 - You should have a 360 degree view of your members and that includes community activity
 - Allows for seamless experience across all your web properties (SSO instead of separate login for the community)
- People who join your organization should automatically be added to the community as a member benefit

1 Whoa! That looks like a lot of work. I don't need this (hint: yes, you do)

5 We integrate to our CRM / AMS and use that information in the community

Identify the Metrics that Matter



OUR FANCY NEW DASHBOARD IS FANCY

- You don't know if you are successful unless you are measuring something
- You can't justify your existence to the powers-that-be without proof that you are hitting your marks
- The success metrics conversation should be one of the first ones you have with your consultant come Monday morning
- Identify the things that matter to you
 - Number of topics
 - Replies to topics ratio
 - Downloaded resources
 - Friend connections
 - Etc...

1 I don't measure any metrics and I don't know what my measures of success are

5 We measure data and make data driven decisions within the community

Homework

Take your scorecard and use it as the basis of your conversation with your Community Consultant or internal team next week!

Come up with a short / long-term plan to fill the gaps!

Q&A



Questions?

Ken Aponte

Sr. Director, Community Solutions

Small World Labs